

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
AGENCIES, SYSTEMS, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL
FILING OR CYBERSECURITY GUIDE**

Judgment

Entered: July 17, 2026 **Synthetic docket:** SYN-CA4-26-CV-4106 **Panel:** Presiding Judge Vale, Judge Quill, and Judge Reed, fictional composite bench profiles

In accordance with the opinion entered today, the district court’s judgment is affirmed only as to DOE’s withholding under Exemption 7(E) of adequately supported nonpublic trigger relationships, response ordering, escalation structure, and implementation details within the fictional operational decision trees.

The judgment is vacated as to DOE’s categorical reliance on Exemption 7(F). That issue is returned for a determination connecting any renewed functional category to a reasonable expectation of danger to an individual. The judgment is also vacated as to segregability. DOE must reassess the current deletions and account for the seventeen passages restored on eleven replacement pages through RLS-OG-002.

The district court’s broad order restricting judicial records is vacated. Any renewed restriction must be evaluated separately, document by document, with public notice, consideration of narrower alternatives, and findings appropriate to the governing right of access. The three vacated matters are remanded for further proceedings. No disclosure on remand may override the 7(E) protection affirmed above.

Effect and Scope

This judgment does not disturb the undisputed search or the fixed universe of twelve responsive records containing 200 source pages. It decides no claim concerning the adequacy of the repositories, search terms, custodians, or reduction from 16,842 raw hits to 1,284 deduplicated candidates and forty-six custodian-reviewed files.

DOE may present narrower 7(F) categories, revised declarations, updated Vaughn entries, or additional releases consistent with the opinion. The district court shall evaluate those materials and the renewed segregability determination under FOIA's distinct requirements. A passage independently protected by the affirmed 7(E) ruling remains withheld even if a second rationale is not sustained.

Judicial-record access shall be reconsidered independently of source-record exemption status. A valid withholding may inform but does not automatically resolve whether an entire litigation filing should be restricted. The interim treatment of the four controlled appellate counterparts remains governed by the May 8 order until its stated review point. Nothing in this judgment converts that temporary arrangement into permanent closure.

Entry and Notice

The appeal is resolved by partial affirmance, partial vacatur, and remand. The district court shall conduct proceedings consistent with the opinion and this judgment. The Clerk shall transmit the disposition through the synthetic docket and maintain public access to the opinion, judgment, docket information, and public counterparts.

The fictional panel reaches no conclusion about whether DOE will establish a narrower safety claim, whether further nonexempt passages will be released, or whether a particular lower-court record will qualify for renewed restriction. Those questions depend on the separate analyses required on remand. The mandate will issue according to the governing appellate schedule unless lawfully altered by a subsequent order.

DOE's status as a United States agency ordinarily supplies a forty-five-day rehearing period. The Court instead orders under Federal Rule of Appellate Procedure 40(d)(1) that any panel or en banc rehearing petition be filed within fourteen days of this judgment, by July 31, 2026. If that date passes without a timely petition or another order, Rule 41(b)'s seven-day interval ends on August 7, 2026, when mandate shall issue.

Entered at the direction of Presiding Judge Vale, Judge Quill, and Judge Reed on July 17, 2026. Copies were served on Tamsin Roe, Leo Marr, and Corin Pell through the synthetic appellate docket. This judgment contains no controlled label or authentic operational information and authorizes none to be added to the record.